

Modernizing HEC Bylaws

Proposed changes to 2002 original bylaws

Key Areas

1. General Membership and Quorum
2. Board Structure and Leadership
3. Election Procedures
4. General Governance



General Membership and Quorum

	CURRENT	PROPOSED
Member Definition(s)	No clear definition, just membership classifications (i.e. attending, general, honorary)	Any adult resident with a physical address in neighborhood (11th to Broad, South to Washington)
Voting Eligibility	Attending voting member: Attend at least five (5) general meetings within a year General member: No requirements, can only vote on community matters Honorary members: Non-voting	Attend at least 1 community meeting within the calendar year to vote on HEC business (elections, finances, etc)
Membership Quorum	50% of attending members; either present or represented by written proxy	15 members

Board Structure and Leadership

	CURRENT	PROPOSED
Board Size	5 members	3 - 7 members
Quorum	Simple majority	Two thirds majority
Term Limits	2 year terms No limits	2 year terms; Limit of 3 consecutive terms, followed by a mandatory 1-year break
Leadership Positions	President Vice President Secretary Treasurer	President Secretary Treasurer Others as needed

Election Procedures

- Simple majority
- Absentee Ballots: Members can request a ballot 72 hours in advance if they cannot attend.



General Governance

- RCO Compliance: Formalized language regarding Philadelphia RCO requirements for transparency and public zoning forums.
- Digital Integration: Formal authorization for virtual/hybrid meetings and electronic communication.
- Standardized Order: Mandatory use of the latest Robert's Rules of Order to ensure fair and structured debate.



Defined Leadership Roles

Current

President

Vice President

Secretary

Treasurer

Proposed

President

~~**VP, Zoning & Development:** Codifies our role as a Registered Community Organization (RCO).~~

~~**VP, Communications & Programs:** Ensures consistent community outreach and event management.~~

Secretary

Treasurer

The board was concerned that it would be difficult to have all 5 positions filled and wanted to ensure that the state minimum of 3 is being met and required in the bylaws. The board would have the possibility of creating other positions (up to additional 4) as people volunteer.